



Chef's Table
at Brooklyn Fare



DAVID SHAW
MAY 27TH, 2022

TARTELETTE

Sugar Snap Pea and its Purée | Mustard Bloom | Herbs

AJI

Aji from Uwajima | Fried Nori | Koshihikari Rice

CAVIAR

Kaluga Caviar | Fish Mousse | Kumamoto Oyster | Veal Tartare
Tomato Dashi | Herb Oil | Potato Crumbs

UNI

Hokkaido Uni | Black Truffle | Brioche

MADAI

Madai from Kyushu | Myoga Ginger | Fish Bone Marrow Sauce
Radish | Cucumber | Hojiso

RAMPS CAPPUCINO

Ramps and Ramps Purée | Cream | Wood Ear
Escargot | Abalone

SAWARA

Sawara from Ishikawa | Cape Gooseberry | Shimeji Mushroom
Sepia | Fava Bean

DUCK

Morel mushroom | Radicchio Purée | Onion Foam | Duck Jus

WAGYU

Wagyu from Kagoshima | Horseradish
Beef Jus | Langres Cheese Sauce | Cipollini Onion Purée | Herb Oil

CANTALOUPE

Fresh Cantaloupe from Japan | Cantaloupe Sorbet | Riesling Gel

STRAWBERRY SOUFFLÉ

Frozen Strawberry Soufflé | Strawberry | Milk Ice Cream | Vanilla Milk Rice Puffs

BLACK TEA

Black Tea Mousse Cake

PETIT FOURS

Soy Caramel Cream Puff | Raspberry Chocolate | Milk Chocolate Banana Tart



TARTELETTE

The tasting menu unfolds on a refreshing tartelette featuring sugar snap pea and its own purée, finished with herbs and mustard bloom. The explosive lusciousness of the sugar snap pea instantly calms the mind down from the hustle and bustle of the city. Cocooned in the sugar snap pea, its own purée reveals an exquisite purity of a refreshing and pristine flavor. Surprisingly, the purée carries a light texture without too much creaminess but instead, an almost gel like texture. The duo forms of the sugar snap pea are further kissed by a bouquet of herbs and mustard blossom that oozes faint nuances of herbal freshness, luminous yet mild acidity, as well as ephemeral peppery hints of spiciness that resemble the dying spark of wasabi.

AJI

The refreshing sugar snap pea tartelette soon fades out as a tsunami of rich oceanic umami flushes in. A gunkanmaki sushi comprised of Aji from Uwajima, fried nori, and koshihikari rice, the next dish showcases a hybrid of traditional gunkanmaki and continental gastronomy. By replacing the traditional fire grilled nori and regular sushi rice with deep fried crispy nori and almost risotto-like creamy rice filling, chef César Ramirez's interpretation is able to radiate more depth and complexity and enraptures the senses with richer dimensions of flavor which meets the international modern gastronomic aesthetics. The fried nori and koshihikari rice prepared with grated wasabi collectively further sublimates and magnify the lightly torched aji's flavor profile of sophisticated sweet oceanic umami and rich unctuousness with hints of obscure acidity, brininess, and smokiness.





CAVIAR

The tsunami of oceanic umami continues to send shockwaves in the next course of caviar, featuring supreme Kaluga caviar nesting on top of a fish mousse marbled with Kumamoto oysters and veal tartare, finished with tomato dashi, herb oil, and potato crumbs. The cloud of fish mousse enlivened by tomato dashi, herb oil, and potato crumbs creates fertile soil for the splendid intro of veal tartare and Kumamoto oyster at the heart of this creation. Such a medley on its own already tastes fabulous, for the duo of veal tartare and Kumamoto oyster creates a one-of-a-kind surf and turf, yet this voluptuous concoction further oozes a unified sensual accord that envelops the caviar in a prismatic symphony of flavors. The explosion of caviar ultimately releases the capricious indulgence of buttery richness, refreshing brininess, and maritime umami that penetrates through every cell of the palate, creating the quintessential hedonism that no aficionado can resist.



UNI TOAST

Succeeding the grandiose symphony of caviar that comprises rich and complicated texture, an aria centered on the immaculate glory of uni is presented. Enunciating unrivaled rich creaminess and tropical fruitiness, the supreme Hokkaido uni mingles with a hidden layer of preserved black truffle and a bed of brioche that altogether emanates an enchanting magnetic aura, engulfing the tongue in a refined sensation that sets off the rarified suave creaminess and overflowing meticulous sweetness saturated by a touch of discreet and almost reticent mild earthiness. The eminent uni toast has been on Chef's Table at Brooklyn Fare's menu forever and is the most acclaimed pièce de résistance of chef César Ramirez. Its presentation has recently been changed. The black truffle medallion used to be at the top of the creation, yet chef César Ramirez chooses to place it between the uni and brioche. By doing so, the earthy aroma of black truffle now blends more discreetly into the concoction, and the purity of uni is finer highlighted.



MADAI

Following the fierce turbulences of richness discharged from the aji, caviar, and uni course, a diaphanously refreshing madai dish as almost a palate cleanser is served to counter the heaviness from previous courses. Sourcing from Kyushu, the elastic yet tender flesh of madai scatters its ephemeral touch of bright elegance and sweetness, which merges with delicious myoga ginger, zesty citrus, and lightly peppery herbal hojiso. A refreshing aqueous touch of cucumber and radish brings in the breath of a spring garden, while the light fish bone marrow jus divulges a unique suaveness to the medley, sublimating the whole to another dimension. This beauteous composition is a marvelous combination of focused delicacy and finesse, which appears to hover on the palate with the grace of a ballerina.

RAMPS CAPPUCINO

Ensued from the madai dish is another intermissive course highlighting ramps drenched in a rich creamy ocean of cream and ramps purée. The creamy cappuccino is further accentuated by wood ears, escargot, and abalone. The duo of escargot and abalone bestows unparalleled bewitching umami on the concoction, sublimating the medley into an enrapturing act of creating a luscious taste and voluptuous texture that escort the ramps to the heaven. One must marvel at how audacious chef César Ramirez is to set both the treasures of the sea and land aside in the background to support the ramps. No other chef dares to give up the opportunity to highlight the escargot or abalone in a dish. Yet such a valorous move works out stupendously, as the brunoised abalone and escargot ooze just enough radiance while avoiding stealing the spotlight of the ramps.





SAWARA

The first of the three main courses presented is the seafood dish featuring sawara from Ishikawa. Counterpointed with cape gooseberries, shimeji, sepia, and fava beans, the sawara is lightly grilled to achieve its yet raw interior and a crispy skin that diffuses smoky fiery aroma resembles hay and charcoal. The aroma in the skin sings in perfect harmony with its rich unctuousness that leaks from the grilled skin, while the inner flesh carries a tender yet meaty texture that mingles with its pristine and mildly sweet umami.

Engulfing the sawara in its rich creamy flavors and suave texture, the sauce further permeates my palate with a sweet blast of cape gooseberries reminiscent of mango and exuberant creaminess and earthy nutty perfume of fava bean and shimeji. In addition, the sepia divulges saline maritime yet milky umami that echoes the mildly sweet flesh of sawara.



DUCK

While the captivating sawara dish keeps delivering sensuality through the palate, the next poultry dish showcasing duck breast lands on the white table linen before long. The wondrous duck breast cooked to a perfect medium rare is lounging in a frothy bubble bath of onion foam where it reverberates with an intense and radiant aura of the morel mushroom further caressed by radicchio purée and duck jus. The resplendent entry of duck breast is sublimated not only by the eclectic duo of onion foam and radicchio purée that exhibits the duality of a sweet and bitter mix but also by the precious earthy and nutty morel mushroom stuffed with a pâté made of foie gras de canard and other chef's secret ingredients that oozes an intense burst of umami. A final touch of duck jus reminiscent of the classical bordelaise sauce is set reverberates with the duck breast, recapitulating the rich duck umami and aroma.



WAGYU

The finale of the savory chapter showcases an ode to the breathtaking wagyu from Kagoshima. Renowned for its tender flesh and concentrated umami and well distributed marbling of shimofuri, the Kagoshima black cattle breed is one of the few most acclaimed wagyu breeds. The fabulous mouthwatering piece of wagyu presented tonight divulges mellow and rich concentrated umami, regardless of the fact that its marbling pales in comparison to the exquisitely marbled Miyazaki wagyu from my last visit. The fine cut of Kagoshima wagyu is further enlivened by a horseradish cream that counters the rich unctuousness while escorting the wagyu to the heart of the flavor profile, where the main core rendezvouses with a psychedelic quartet comprising Langres cheese sauce, Cipollini onion purée, beef jus, and herb oil that plays a flirtatious game of seduction. The Langres cheese intertwined with onion purée, forming a robust full-bodied magnetic ground underscored by the noble presence of beef jus and an ethereal olfactive flowing line of herb oil. Altogether, the quartet sublimates the majestic wagyu to another dimension, marking the terminal flowering of the medley of enchanting aromas and umami.



CANTALOUPE

A palate cleanser course centers on the cantaloupe is served after the sumptuous main-course trio. Consists of a quenelle of cantaloupe sorbet, a scoop of fresh cantaloupe, and a riesling wine gel, the dish exhibits the refreshing succulent nature of cantaloupe and its well-balanced sweetness and sourness accentuated by the riesling that oozes a twist of sharp acidity, multidimensional fruitiness, highly aromatic floral nose, and hints of irresistible gasoline smell. Though the cantaloupe can never reach the delicate texture and highly aromatic sweetness of a Shizuoka melon, it does add a texture to counter the suave sorbet and gel texture and neutralize the heavy richness that lingers on the palate with its clean and pristine aroma and flavor, constituting a stepping stone to the following desserts.

STRAWBERRY SOUFFLÉ

The cantaloupe course paves the way for the grandiose and splendid entry of the well-respected frozen soufflé course. No one could possibly refuse the glorious radiation of this frozen soufflé at Chef's Table at Brooklyn Fare, and it is, without doubt, a mythical creature that occupies the menu for years. The flavor of this course keeps changing over seasons, and currently served is a strawberry frozen soufflé nestling on top of a milk ice cream finished with fresh cuts of strawberry and some vanilla milk rice puffs. Chef César Ramirez pushes the boundary of exploring an ultimate airy texture for the frozen soufflé. He indeed presents us with the mind-blowing delicate and tenuous texture reminiscent of a softest sigh in the mouth. Truth be told, a showstopper that screams rare charisma and charms.





BLACK TEA & PETIT FOURS

In between the main dessert and the petit fours comes in an interlude of black tea mousse cake. The simple cake is well made with a rich and authentic black tea aroma as well as a light velvety texture that delivers sensuality from the moment it touches the palate. The final bites of the whole degustation journey are soy caramel cream puff, raspberry chocolate truffle balls, and milk chocolate banana tart, all of which are well executed yet somehow overwhelming for the palate after a rich mousse cake and at the end of a lavish meal.

SERVICE

Generally speaking, the staffs at Chef's Table at Brooklyn Fare are well trained with good manners but lack some essential expertise. The black sheep of the team is the new sommelier who seems too sloppy and halfwitted to handle multiple tables of customers. One of our champagne flutes is contaminated by a fly, and we asked for a replacement. We waited for over ten minutes before receiving a new glass of our sparkling tea beverage which comes together with his most insincere argument saying he never forgot. Some of the other servers are unfamiliar with the menu and fail to answer many of my questions. One lady who seems to be part of their middle management is able to provide many details of the ingredients I ask about. Yet shockingly she tries to fool me with some obviously wrong answers, namely addressing the shiso flower as a zucchini flower which neither matches the color nor the size. It is also the same lady who forget to light a birthday candle on the cake which is a commonsense approach in many restaurants at even lower level. The maitre d' is the most informed one on the team who not only answers all my remaining questions at the end of the meal but also comes to apologize for the missing candle and chat with me before seeing us out.

